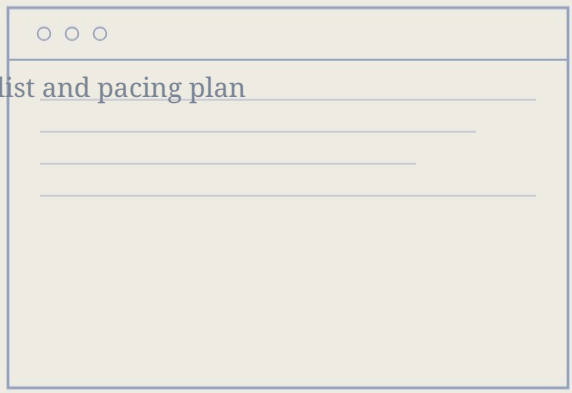
DATA SYSTEMS ADMINISTRATOR COURSE · MODULE 01

INSTRUCTOR GUIDE

SPEAKER NOTES FOR EVERY SLIDE

Windows Foundations — what to say, what to emphasize, and what to ask, slide by slide.

22 slides · ≈ 90-minute session · Includes prep checklist and pacing plan



How to Use This Guide

One block of notes per slide, in deck order. Scripts are written the way you'd actually say them — steal the wording or make it your own. The labels repeat throughout:

- **SAY** — a natural script for the slide — roughly what comes out of your mouth.
- **EMPHASIZE** — the points students must walk away with — slow down here.
- **ASK THE CLASS** — an engagement question with the answer you're fishing for.
- **DEMO / WATCH FOR / TRANSITION** — live-demo moves, common misconceptions, and bridges to the next slide.

Before Class: 10-Minute Prep Checklist

- ☐ Projector mirrors your desktop — students must see your Start menu and taskbar, not just the slides.
- ☐ Training PCs are powered on and every student can sign in.
- ☐ Software Center opens on the training PCs — it should, but check before class.
- ☐ Task Manager opens on the training PCs — some organizations restrict it. If it's blocked, demo on your machine while they watch.
- ☐ Have a machine name or IP ready if you plan a live Remote Desktop connection — otherwise narrate it from the slides.
- ☐ Print one student handout and one cheat sheet per learner — hand them out at slide 21.

Pacing Plan — ≈ 90 Minutes

Slides	Segment	Time
1–2	Welcome & course map	4 min
3–4	Stop 1 · Navigation	8 min
5–6	Stop 2 · Lock screen	6 min
7–8	Stop 3 · The desktop	7 min
9–10	Stop 4 · Settings	7 min
11–12	Stop 5 · Task Manager	10 min
13–14	Stop 6 · Software Center	6 min
15–16	Stop 7 · Remote Desktop	8 min
17–19	Stop 8 · File Explorer	11 min
20	Hands-on lab	15 min
21–22	Cheat sheet & wrap-up	5 min

> **RUNNING LONG?** Trim slides 8 and 18 down to the schematics and let the handout carry the detail — that buys back about five minutes without touching the lab, which is the part students remember.

Speaker Notes by Slide

SLIDE 1 · ≈ 2 MIN

Windows Foundations (Title)

SAY *"Welcome in. This course turns you into a data systems administrator — and it starts right here, with the machine in front of you. By the end of today you'll move around Windows like someone who does this for a living: signing in, locking up, fixing a frozen app, even driving a computer you can't physically touch. No prior IT experience needed — bring curiosity."*

EMPHASIZE This is hands-on and entry level — nobody in the room is behind. Every skill today gets practiced in the lab at the end.

ASK THE CLASS "Show of hands — who's ever had a computer freeze at the worst possible moment?" Every hand goes up. "By the end of class, you'll know exactly what to do about it."

TRANSITION "Here's our route for today."

SLIDE 2 · ≈ 2 MIN

Course Map — 8 Stops

SAY *"Eight stops today. We'll start by getting around without getting lost, learn to lock up in one second, tour the desktop and the Settings app, look under the hood with Task Manager, install software the safe way, drive a PC remotely, and finish with files — finding, moving, and organizing them. Then a hands-on lab where you prove every skill."*

EMPHASIZE Don't read all eight stops word for word — gesture at the arc: get around → stay safe → fix things → files. The lab is the payoff.

TRANSITION "Stop one: three tools that get you anywhere."

SLIDE 3 · ≈ 4 MIN

Stop 1 · Navigation — Three Tools

SAY *"Getting lost in Windows is completely normal. The difference between a new user and an admin isn't that admins never get lost — it's that they know three exits. The Start menu lists every app on the PC. Search finds anything: press the Win key and just start typing. And the taskbar shows what's open and holds your pinned favorites."*

EMPHASIZE Search is the pro habit. Typing three letters beats digging through five menus — admins search more than they browse.

DEMO Do it live: press Win, type "settings", hit Enter. Then right-click the Start button to reveal the hidden admin menu — students love this one.

WATCH FOR Students hunting for a search box — on Windows 11 you just press Win and type. No clicking needed.

SLIDE 4 · ≈ 4 MIN

Stop 1 · Six Shortcuts

SAY *"Six shortcuts worth memorizing — but not today. Start with three: Win, Alt + Tab, and Win + L. The rest will stick with practice. Read a combo like this: hold the first key, tap the second, let go."*

EMPHASIZE Win + D toggles — press it again and your windows come back. Alt + Tab cycles — hold Alt, tap Tab to move through open windows.

DEMO Thirty seconds of play: "Everyone — press Win + D. Again. Now hold Alt and tap Tab through your windows." Muscle memory starts here.

ASK THE CLASS "Which of the six do you think you'll use most?" Take two or three answers — Win and Alt + Tab usually win.

SLIDE 5 · ≈ 3 MIN

Stop 2 · The Lock Screen — Front Door

SAY *"The lock screen is what Windows shows before anyone signs in — it greets you, and it guards the PC. It shows the time, date, battery, network, and the notifications you allow. Click or press any key, then sign in with your password or PIN."*

EMPHASIZE Password vs. PIN: your password works anywhere, including company services; a PIN lives only on this one device — stolen, it's useless anywhere else.

ASK THE CLASS "Why would a company prefer you sign in with a PIN on your laptop?" Fishing for: it never leaves the device.

SLIDE 6 · ≈ 3 MIN

Stop 2 · Lock It. Every Time.

SAY *"If you tattoo one habit from this course, make it this one: Win + L every time you step away. Even for coffee. One second, and everything you have open is protected. Locking keeps your apps running underneath — signing out closes everything, and that's for the end of the day."*

EMPHASIZE Lock ≠ sign out. An unlocked, unattended PC is an open door to company data — someone could read email, copy files, or send messages as you. Curiosity isn't malice, but it's still a risk. Most workplaces also require locking by policy.

ASK THE CLASS "Be honest — who's walked away from an unlocked PC?" Smile. "After today, nobody in this room."

SLIDE 7 · ≈ 4 MIN

Stop 3 · The Desktop — Five Parts

SAY *"The desktop is your workbench. Icons are shortcuts to apps, files, and folders — double-click to open. The wallpaper is yours to change. Bottom-left is the Start button. The taskbar holds your pinned apps — and a small line under an icon means that app is running. On the right, the tray and clock."*

EMPHASIZE Line under icon = running. That one detail makes the whole taskbar readable.

DEMO Switch to your real desktop on the projector and name the parts aloud — then point at random spots and have the class name them back. Thirty seconds of call-and-response.

SLIDE 8 · ≈ 3 MIN

Stop 3 · Taskbar, Zone by Zone

SAY *"Four zones, left to right: Start, Search, your pinned and running apps, and the tray with the clock. Click the tray corner for quick settings — Wi-Fi, volume, battery toggles. And see the little arrow in the tray? It hides the icons that don't fit."*

EMPHASIZE Pin your top five tools on day one: right-click any app → Pin to taskbar. Most admins pin File Explorer, Settings, and Task Manager first.

DEMO Have everyone do it now: right-click File Explorer in Start → Pin to taskbar. Ten seconds, one new habit.

RUNNING LONG? This slide compresses well — the zones are labeled right on the schematic. Don't linger.

SLIDE 9 · ≈ 4 MIN

Stop 4 · Settings — One Menu

SAY *"The Settings app runs the whole PC — how it looks, connects, updates, and behaves. Three ways in: press Win + I from anywhere, open Start and click the gear, or right-click Start and choose Settings. And here's the pro tip: don't browse — search."*

EMPHASIZE Win + I is the fastest way in. The search box inside Settings is the real superpower — type what you want and jump straight to it.

DEMO Live: Win + I, type "display" in the Settings search box, hit Enter — you land exactly on the right page. Let them see you NOT browsing categories.

SLIDE 10 · ≈ 3 MIN

Stop 4 · The Five Panels

SAY *"Five panels cover most of your week. System: display, sound, storage, About this PC. Network & Internet: Wi-Fi, Ethernet, VPN. Accounts: passwords, PINs, sign-in options. Windows Update: patches and restart scheduling. Personalization: wallpaper and lock screen pictures. Control Panel still exists for old-school tools, but Settings covers about ninety percent of daily admin work."*

EMPHASIZE You don't need to memorize every panel — you need to know they exist so the search box can find them.

ASK THE CLASS "A user says their Wi-Fi dropped. Which panel?" Network & Internet. "Their password?" Accounts.

SLIDE 11 · ≈ 4 MIN

Stop 5 · Task Manager — Dashboard

SAY *"Task Manager shows everything running on the PC and how hard each part is working. When something feels slow or stuck, this is your first stop — the PC's dashboard. Open it with Ctrl + Shift + Esc: one hand, three keys. Four tabs matter: Processes, Performance, Startup apps, and Users."*

EMPHASIZE Translate the dials: CPU is the brain — 100% means flat out. Memory is short-term workspace — when it fills, everything slows. Disk and network are activity meters.

DEMO Open Task Manager live. On Processes, click the Memory column to sort — the hungriest app floats to the top. Then flash the Performance tab graphs.

SLIDE 12 · ≈ 6 MIN

Stop 5 · Unfreeze an App in 4 Steps

SAY *“An app freezes. First move: nothing. Wait thirty seconds — many apps recover on their own. Still stuck? Ctrl + Shift + Esc, find the app on the Processes tab — it will say "Not responding" — click it once, click End task, then reopen the app. Windows closes just that app. Unsaved work inside it is gone; everything else is safe.”*

EMPHASIZE The last-resort rule: End task throws away unsaved work in that app only — that's why we wait first. Success looks like: the frozen window closes and your other apps stay open.

DEMO You can't freeze an app on command, so narrate over live Task Manager instead: "If this app froze, I'd click here… End task here." Students follow the clicks.

ASK THE CLASS "Why wait 30 seconds before ending the task?" Fishing for: apps often recover on their own, and End task discards unsaved work.

SLIDE 13 · ≈ 3 MIN

Stop 6 · Software Center

SAY *“Software Center is the company app store. Every app on the list is IT-approved, installs without an admin password, and keeps itself updated — licenses handled, no keys to type. Find it: press Win, type Software Center, hit Enter. Can't find what you need? Request it from IT.”*

EMPHASIZE Three reasons it exists: approved and safe, no admin rights needed, licenses managed behind the scenes.

DEMO Open Software Center live and browse the list — students will check it against their own training PCs in the lab.

SLIDE 14 · ≈ 3 MIN

Stop 6 · Get Apps the Safe Way

SAY *“The rules are simple. Do: install from Software Center, say yes to updates, restart when updates ask, and request what you can't find. Don't: download installers from random websites, click "Free download!" ads, share licensed installers, or snooze restarts for days.”*

EMPHASIZE Land this line: unapproved software is the number-one way malware walks into a company. One random download can undo a whole security team. Restarts aren't nagging — patches close security holes.

ASK THE CLASS "Why do companies lock down installs so tightly?" One bad download affects everyone, not just you.

SLIDE 15 · ≈ 4 MIN

Stop 7 · Remote Desktop — The Concept

SAY *"Remote Desktop — RDP — shows another Windows PC's screen in a window on yours, and lets you control it as if you were sitting there. Your mouse and keyboard work on both. Admins use it to fix a user's PC without leaving their desk, manage servers that have no monitor, or reach their work PC from home."*

EMPHASIZE Four things must be true or the connection fails: the remote PC is powered on, it's on the network, it's set to allow Remote Desktop, and your account has permission. When RDP fails, check those four in order before anything fancier.

ASK THE CLASS "Why would a server have no monitor?" It lives in a server room or data center — nobody sits at it; you reach it over the network.

SLIDE 16 · ≈ 4 MIN

Stop 7 · Connect in Four Moves

SAY *"Four moves. One: open the tool — Win, type Remote Desktop Connection, or just mstsc, Enter. Two: name the machine — its computer name or IP address — and Connect. Three: sign in with your own username and password. Four: finish right — sign out when the work is done."*

EMPHASIZE The safety rules matter more than the steps: authorized machines only — connecting is a permission, not a right. Never save passwords on shared PCs. And always sign out.

WATCH FOR Students assume closing the RDP window logs them off. It doesn't — it leaves them logged in on that machine. Hammer this: window closed ≠ signed out.

SLIDE 17 · ≈ 4 MIN

Stop 8 · File Explorer — The Four Zones

SAY *"File Explorer is the filing cabinet of Windows — press Win + E to open it. Four zones: the Ribbon up top for actions like copy, move, and new folder. The address bar, which shows where you are as breadcrumbs. The navigation pane on the left with shortcuts to Quick access and This PC. And the file list — your actual files and folders."*

EMPHASIZE Breadcrumbs are clickable — click any crumb to jump straight back to that folder. No more pressing Back ten times.

DEMO Live: Win + E, drill two folders deep, then click a crumb in the address bar to jump back. Point at each zone as you name it.

SLIDE 18 · ≈ 4 MIN

Stop 8 · Every File Has an Address

SAY *"Every file has an address, and it reads like a story. C:\Users\Ana\Documents\report.docx: the C: drive — the PC's main storage. Users\Ana — whose folder it is, one per user. Documents — a box inside the box. And report.docx — the file, where .docx tells you the type. Drive letters: C: is the main drive, D: or E: are usually USB sticks or extra drives, and letters like S: or H: are network drives — shared company folders."*

EMPHASIZE The extension tells you the file type — .docx, .xlsx, .pdf, .zip, .exe. And the line that saves careers: network drives are backed up; your Desktop usually isn't.

ASK THE CLASS "Where's the safest place to save something important?" The network drive — or at minimum, Documents.

SLIDE 19 · ≈ 3 MIN

Stop 8 · Six Moves You'll Use Daily

SAY *"Six daily moves. Copy and paste duplicates a file. Cut and paste moves it. F2 renames — clear names save you later. Ctrl + Shift + N makes a new folder. The search box searches inside the folder you're standing in. And Delete sends files to the Recycle Bin — your safety net; you can open it and restore anything."*

EMPHASIZE Heads-up moment: Shift + Delete skips the Recycle Bin — gone for good. Tell students to avoid it for now. And the house rule: save to Documents or your network drive, not the Desktop or Downloads.

SLIDE 20 · ≈ 15 MIN

Hands-On Lab — 15 Minutes

SAY *"Fifteen minutes, six tasks, training PCs. Work with a partner — check each task off together, and say out loud what you're doing as you do it. Teaching your hands out loud is the fastest way to make it stick. "Done" means you can repeat each task without looking at your notes."*

LOGISTICS Pair students up. Demo task one (lock and unlock with Win + L) before starting the clock — it breaks the ice and shows the standard.

DURING THE LAB Circulate. Fast finishers: hand them the cheat sheet (slide 21) and have them quiz each other. Struggling pairs: sit with them once, then let them struggle — that's the learning.

SLIDE 21 · ≈ 3 MIN

First-Week Cheat Sheet

SAY *"This page is your first-week survival kit — print it, fold it, live with it. PC feels slow? Task Manager. App frozen? Wait, then End task. Need an app? Software Center. Stepping away? Win + L, every time. After two weeks, your fingers will know it by heart."*

LOGISTICS Hand out the printed cheat sheets and student handouts now — not at the door. Students skim them while energy is high.

EMPHASIZE The left column is the shortcuts; the right column is the "when this happens → do this" map. Both are in the handout too.

SLIDE 22 · ≈ 2 MIN

Wrap-Up — You Can Drive Windows Now

SAY *"Look how far that was. You can navigate, lock, tweak settings, watch Task Manager, install safely, connect remotely, and keep files tidy — the daily moves of a data systems administrator. Next module: User Accounts & Permissions — who gets in, and what they're allowed to touch."*

ASK THE CLASS "One thing you learned today that you'll actually use tonight?" Take two or three answers — Win + L and Alt + Tab are the usual winners. End on that energy.

If Students Ask...

Four questions that come up in almost every class, with answers you can give on the spot.

“Why not just close the laptop lid instead of locking?” Closing the lid usually just puts the PC to sleep — and depending on the setup, it may not even lock. Win + L is instant, certain, and one second. Make it the habit; the lid is for travel.

“What if End task doesn't work?” Wait a little longer and try once more. If the app truly won't die, save your other work and restart the PC — that's the real last resort. And let it be a lesson: save early, save often.

“Can I use Remote Desktop from my house?” Only if your company allows it — usually through a VPN and with explicit permission. RDP is a powerful door into the network, which is exactly why the rule is "authorized machines only."

“I deleted something by accident — now what?” Check the Recycle Bin first — right-click the file → Restore, and it goes back where it came from. If it was Shift + Deleted or the Bin was emptied, tell IT quickly — files on network drives can often be recovered from backups. Speed matters.

> **CLOSING MOVE** End every session the same way you want students to end every workday: say "lock it, every time," press Win + L on your own machine, and let them watch the screen lock. Habits are caught, not taught.